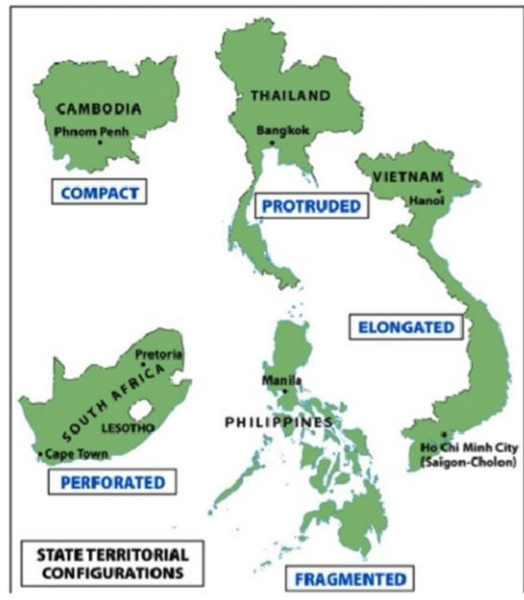




State Morphology

- Cultural impacts
 - Isolation and divergence
- Political impacts
 - Separatist movements
 - Irredentism
- Economic impacts
 - Unequal economic development
 - Resource rich/poor compared to rest of state
 - Limited integration to economy



State morphology is the study of how the shape of a country can affect its culture, politics, economy, and overall wellbeing. Shapes aren't always something we think about when considering why states act the ways they do, but there's actually a lot to be said about the geometry of the human world.

This challenge to government has already been discussed (Political Boundaries notes, State morphology reference sheet, and page 228 in you book).

The shape of a state can influence the politics, culture, economy, etc. because it determines how connected/disconnected people are. Groups of people with economic, political, or cultural characteristics that differ greatly from the main part of the state are much more likely to develop in “fringe” parts of the state – this is even more pronounced if physical geographic features such as a large body of water or mountain range further isolate the fringe groups. It is a challenge for governments to integrate these dissimilar groups into the main political/cultural/economic

Technological Change

- Benefits
 - Expand ability to control territory
 - Movement of goods (international trade)
 - Effective communication
 - Increased involvement in global politics and conflict (geopolitics)
- Challenges
 - Increased movement of people (can create immigration issues)
 - Increased interactions with other states (both trade and politics)
 - Increased involvement in global politics and conflicts (geopolitics)



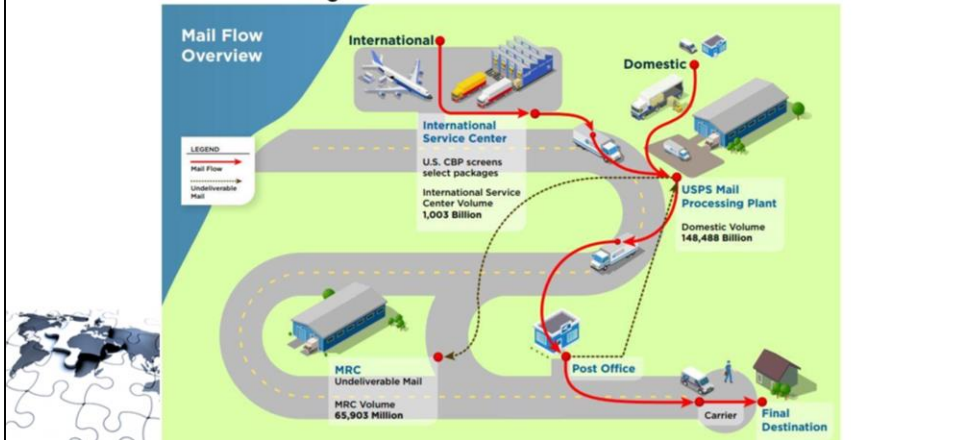
In historical times, the concept of “state” did not really exist because places were isolated from each other with frontier boundaries between them. These disconnected kingdoms or city-states were small and compact, and their territory only stretched so far as the government’s “reach” into the hinterland (the area that supplies the resources for the economy of a place and falls under the economic and political influence of a central place – think back to “centrality”). As the influence of one government (king, ruler, etc.) faded out, there was unclaimed territory known as the frontier. If one traveled across the frontier, eventually they would enter into another government’s hinterland.

Changes to technology forced people to change their view of territory and power. Only after improved technology allowed for explorers to begin seeking new resources and land did the concept of the modern day state form – around 500 years ago. Wars over territory resulted in codifying a system of understanding for the modern-day state (Treaty of Westphalia, 1648).

And, yes, increased involvement in global politics and conflict is listed under both benefits and challenges – it is beneficial for a state to be involved in global politics, but when things go bad, it tends to get really bad really quickly (i.e., World War I and World War II). Overall, though, the international community is interested in keeping the peace, and improved communications with other countries has contributed to meeting that goal.

Transportation technology

- Communication between government and people
- Defense – facilitates movement of troops and supplies
- Trade – movement of goods



Transportation is critical for the development of civilizations. In historical times, people were limited by how far they could walk or how far they could move in a given day by animal transport (usually pulling a wagon of some form). With the advent of ships, explorers were able to travel great distances to find new resources - this led to an interaction of people from different parts of the world and the earliest systems of international trade by sea. Limited transportation was isolating, but it was also a protection - if your location is difficult to get to, it will be difficult to attack. This is why many early cities were built at defensive sites, surrounded by water or mountains. The water access was also beneficial for trade, as water transport was much easier and therefore less expensive than moving goods over land, especially the bulky or heavy items such as lumber, stones, etc.

Economic impact Improvements to transportation technology have made it so that multiple forms of transit (car, trains, planes, etc.) are accessible to most people. But transportation also consumes a lot of resources like time, fuel, materials and land. It requires a significant financial investment for infrastructure. Places that benefit from these investments thrive economically, while those who do not have access to the lines (railroad, highways, etc.) suffer due to the uneven infrastructure development. Transportation is cheaper and faster today than it has ever been before. This results in much more global interactions and resource consumption as an increase in the efficiency of supply results in an increase in the total amount of goods available for consumption. Countries are increasingly trading with each other, and the production of any one item may require coordination and

exchange between 3 or more countries. Transportation is critical to the economic development of a country, and major cities develop along river junctions, railroad junctions, and ports.

Political impact The world is divided into political units (countries or sub-national, such as US states). Transportation plays an important role in the functioning of such political units. The government of an area must be able to effectively communicate with its people. This communication may include laws to be followed, security, and other notices needed to generate awareness. An efficient administration of a country largely depends on how effectively the government can communicate with the different parts of the country. The primary function of transportation is the transfer of messages and information (this is why the US created the United States Postal Service in the Constitution). It is also needed for rapid movement of troops in case of emergency, and also for the movement of people and goods. At the outbreak of the Civil War, there was an estimated 100 miles of disconnected railroads in the US south - they were mostly built to transport cotton/other agricultural products to the port cities for shipment via water. Conversely, the north had a well-developed and connected railroad system. The south was at a significant disadvantage for the movement of troops and supplies. During World War I and World War II in Europe, railroad lines and bridges were a common target of bombing raids in order to cut off supply lines and the movement of soldiers of the opposing side. During times of peace, railroads are vital for shipping goods as it is the 2nd least expensive mode of transportation (with water routes being the cheapest). In the post World War II era, the US undertook a massive infrastructure project with the construction of the interstate highway system. The official name of this infrastructure development project is the Dwight D. Eisenhower National System of Interstate and Defense Highways (named for President Eisenhower). This network of high-speed roadways were designed for the rapid movement of troops during a time of war, but for the use of civilians for economic purposes during times of peace. And, as transportation is vital to a country for effective communications, the interstate highways also serves the US Postal Service.

Communications Technology



Prior to the invention of the telegraph, communications over long distances had to be written, and any non-written communications were limited by sight distance (flags, lights, etc.) – this is one reason why the postal service was such a priority to the US, as discussed on the previous slide. The telegraph, operational as of 1844, changed the way people communicate since people could communicate complex messages over long distances almost instantly – however, an operator had to be on each end of the line to transmit/receive the message. The first trans-Atlantic communications cable was laid in 1858. In 1955, the first telephone cable stretched across the Atlantic, and for the first time people on opposite sides of the ocean could have a real-time conversation. Talks of dedicated communications lines (“hotlines”) between government officials across international boundaries were soon proposed.

The 1962 Cuban Missile Crisis made the hotline a priority. During the standoff between the US and Soviet Union at the height of the Cold War (threatened nuclear war between the two countries), official diplomatic messages typically took six hours to deliver. As an alternative, unofficial channels, such as via television network correspondents, were often used too as they were quicker. During the crisis, the United States took nearly twelve hours to receive and decode Nikita Khrushchev’s (the Soviet Premier (leader)) 3,000-word initial settlement message – a dangerously long time. By the time Washington (the US government) had drafted a reply, a tougher message from Moscow had been received, demanding that U.S. missiles be removed from Turkey. White House advisers thought faster communications could have averted the crisis, and resolved it quicker. The two countries signed the Hot Line

Agreement in June 1963 – the first time they formally took action to cut the risk of starting a nuclear war unintentionally due to delayed communications. This line is officially known as the Washington–Moscow Direct Communications Link. The image above is a political cartoon published upon news that the hotline would be installed linking the leaders of the two rival countries.

Today, direct communications between governments is conducted over secure email.

The internet and ability of communication to spread rapidly is both a benefit and a challenge to government. Social media, especially, has played an import role in spreading dissent and spurring protests and revolts against government (i.e., the Arab Spring, as discussed in the culture unit).



In this case, **globalization** refers to the process by which businesses or other organizations develop international influence or start operating on an international scale.

A **Transnational corporation** is any enterprise (business) that undertakes foreign direct investment, owns or controls income-gathering assets in more than one country, produces goods or services outside its country of origin, or engages in international production“. **Direct Foreign Investment** is investment in the form of a controlling ownership in a business in one country by an entity based in another country. – this means that the person or group who owns/controls the company is controlling it from outside of the country. Profits go back to the business owner (which means they leave the country).

Why transnational corporations are a challenge to governance:

Large corporations are some of the most powerful economic and political entities in many countries. They have had an important role in driving socio-economic development and economic growth since the 1960s and are significantly affecting the way in which people produce and consume goods and services within and across borders. More recently, some nations have started viewing transnational corporations as more of a nuisance than a benefit. The foreign direct investment (FDI) of some of these corporations has benefited some countries of Southeast Asia by building the capacity for manufacturing value-added products (products that can be sold for high

profit). However, some FDI/corporations based on natural resource extraction in many mineral-rich less developed countries take more than they give – their investment does nothing to improve the host country's production capacity (the infrastructure built only benefits the transnational corporation), while the profits for the natural resources leave the country instead of properly compensating the local community. Therefore, concerns have been raised in the international community about sustainability and social responsibility of transnational corporations – particularly in those host countries with extensive mining operations. The concerns expressed over transnational corporations mirror those of concerns over imperialism during the colonial era.